🤖 Robotics Integration Orchestrator: Startup Playbook

Île-de-France | November 2026 | Phase 1: 0–6 Months
By: [Your Company Name] · Founders: [Name A] & [Name B]

🎯 Executive Summary: 10 Things You Must Know

#	Insight	Implication	Next Action (7 Days)
1	Your idea works as a Phase 1 wedge, but not as a long-term model. Pure referral = thin margins (3–10%) and risk of bypass.	Pivot to paid services: diagnostics, subsidy filing, AMO.	Define 3 paid services with price lists.
2	Fastest revenue = paid discovery. Charge €1,000–5,000 for a 1-day robotics audit. 80% of SMEs will take a free call, but 10–20% will pay for a diagnostic—those are real buyers.	Sell diagnostics first, not referrals.	Create a 1-page diagnostic offer (FR+EN).
3	Île-de-France has ~12,000 manufacturing SMEs (INSEE 2024). If 5% adopt robotics/year, that's 600 projects/year. At €2,500 avg. capture, that's €1.5M/year—but only if you own the relationship.	Focus on 200 high-potential targets (logistics, food, pharma, metal).	Pull a list of 200 companies from Kompass or Societe.com (NAF 10–33, 49–52).
4	EU Machinery Regulation 2023/1230 applies from 20 Jan 2027. Until then, CE marking under the old directive is valid. Importing non-EU robots = €10k–50k/year compliance cost.	Avoid importing hardware in Phase 1. Stick to EU-based vendors (Stäubli, KUKA, OTTO, MiR).	List 10 EU-compliant vendors for top 3 use cases.
5	Subsidies are your secret weapon. France 2030 (€2B for robotics), Bpifrance, Région IDF, OPCOs offer 30–50% grants. You can charge 10–15% of the subsidy to file.	Become the subsidy expert. Higher margin (€5k–15k/file) and stickier than referrals.	Download 2026 subsidy guides from Bpifrance and CRAMIF.
6	RaaS is growing 40%/year (ABI Research 2025) but requires €50k–200k/robot capital. Not for Phase 1.	Partner with a RaaS provider (e.g., Exotec, OTTO) and take 10–20% commission on monthly fees.	Identify 3 RaaS vendors to white-label.
7	Biggest risk: Lack of technical credibility. Clients will ask: "Can you guarantee this will work?" You cannot.	Position as the "neutral translator." Bring a freelance integrator on revenue share.	Find 1–2 freelancers on Malt or Upwork (€80–120/hour).
8	AI unlocks new use cases, but 90% of robotics failures are mechanical, not AI.	Focus on mature, high-ROI use cases: palletising, AMRs, machine tending. Avoid humanoids.	Pick 3 use cases to master first.
9	Compounding assets: (1) SME needs database, (2) Vendor price/performance benchmark, (3) Subsidy playbook, (4) Case studies, (5) Partner network.	Every call must feed the database.	Set up Notion/Airtable with fields: Company, NAF, Pain, Budget, Timeline, Decision Maker.
10	You can start TOMORROW with €0 capital. But must charge for something within 30 days or you're just a lead-gen agency.	Sell diagnostics, not referrals.	Book 10 calls this week.

🔍 Idea Stress-Test: What Works & What's Broken

✅ Strengths

Strength	Why It Matters	How to Leverage
Low capital	No inventory, no R&D.	Start immediately.
First-mover in neutral orchestration	Most integrators are brand-aligned.	Position as "the only vendor-agnostic robotics advisor in IDF."
Leverages your skills	Founder B = French + client calls. Founder A = data + ROI.	Founder A builds the database, Founder B sells.
Rides EU tailwinds	France 2030 (€2B robotics), EU Green Deal, labour shortages.	Lead with subsidies.

❌ Weaknesses & Fixes

Weakness	Risk	Mitigation
Thin margins on referrals	3–10% of €50k project = €1.5k–5k.	Upsell to paid diagnostics (€2k–5k) + AMO (10–20%).
Bypassed by vendors	Clients cut you out once they trust a vendor.	Insert AMO contract with non-circumvention clause.
No technical credibility	Clients won't trust recommendations.	Partner with freelance integrator (revenue share).
CE compliance risk	Importing non-EU robots = liability nightmare.	Only work with EU-certified vendors in Phase 1.
After-sales expectations	Clients expect support, training, maintenance.	Clarify in contract: "We connect, you own the vendor relationship."
Long sales cycles	Robotics projects take 6–18 months.	Sell small, fast wins (e.g., cobot palletiser for €30k).

💰 Where You Capture Value (Realistic € & %)

Revenue Stream	% or €	Time to First Revenue	Scalability	Defensibility
Referral fees	3–10% of hardware	30–60 days	Low	Low
Paid diagnostics	€1,000–5,000/audit	14–30 days	Medium	Medium
Subsidy filing	10–15% of subsidy (€5k–15k/file)	30–90 days	High	High
AMO (Project Management)	10–20% of project	60–90 days	Medium	Medium
Hardware resale	10–30% margin	90+ days	Medium	Low
Maintenance contracts	5–15% of hardware/year	180+ days	High	Medium
RaaS commission	10–20% of monthly fee	90+ days	High	Medium

→ **Phase 1 Focus (0–6 months):** ✅ Paid diagnostics (€2k–5k) ✅ Subsidy filing (€5k–15k) ✅ Referral fees (€1.5k–5k)

📊 Business Model Comparison (Score 1–5)

Model	Capital	Speed to Revenue	Margin	Defensibility	Scalability	Fit for Non-Engineers	Total /30
Pure Connector	5	5	2	2	3	5	22
Neutral Advisor + Paid Diagnostics	**4**	**4**	**4**	**3**	**3**	**5**	**23**
Neutral Advisor + AMO	3	3	5	4	4	4	23
Single-Brand Reseller	2	2	4	3	3	3	17
Integrator	1	1	5	5	4	1	17
RaaS Operator	1	1	4	4	5	2	17
Software/Marketplace	2	1	5	5	5	3	21

🏆 **Winner for Phase 1:** Neutral Advisor + Paid Diagnostics + Subsidy Filing

🚀 Phased Path (0–18 Months)

Phase 1: Validate & Monetise (0–6 Months)

Goal: Prove demand, generate first revenue, build database. **Target:** €50k–100k revenue.

Metric	Target	Trigger for Phase 2
Calls made	200	50 qualified leads
Diagnostics sold	10	€20k–50k revenue
Referral fees	€10k	3 successful referrals
Subsidy files	5	€25k–75k revenue
Database entries	200	50% conversion to leads

Actions

- **Week 1:** Define ICP, pull 200-target list, draft cold-call script.
- **Week 2:** Set up CRM, launch LinkedIn outreach.
- **Week 3:** First 50 calls, book 10 diagnostics.
- **Month 2:** Hire freelance integrator (revenue share), file first subsidy.
- **Month 3:** Publish first case study, launch subsidy playbook.

Phase 2: Scale & Differentiate (6–18 Months)

Goal: Add higher-margin services, build partnerships. **Target:** €300k–700k revenue.

Metric	Target
AMO contracts	5
RaaS partnerships	3
Subsidy files	20
Database entries	1,000
Recurring revenue	€5k/month

Actions

- **Month 6:** Launch AMO offering, partner with 3 RaaS vendors.
- **Month 9:** Develop simple matching tool (Google Sheets → Airtable).
- **Month 12:** Hire first employee (sales or operations).
- **Month 15:** Expand to 1–2 new regions (Lyon, Bordeaux).
- **Month 18:** Pilot white-label RaaS or subscription platform.

📞 Sales Playbook (Minimum Viable)

1️⃣ Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Criteria	Details
Industry	Manufacturing (NAF 10–33), Logistics (NAF 49–52), Warehousing (NAF 52.1)
Location	Île-de-France (priority: Zone Industrielle de Paris Nord, Roissy, Orly, Saclay)
Size	50–500 employees, €5M–50M revenue

Pain Points	Labour shortages, repetitive tasks, safety incidents, throughput bottlenecks
Decision Maker	FR: Responsable Production / Logistique / Maintenance EN: Production / Logistics / Maintenance Manager
Budget	€30k–200k for first robotics project
Buying Cycle	3–12 months

2️⃣ Cold-Call Script (FR + EN)

🇫🇷 Français

Ouverture : « Bonjour [Prénom], je m'appelle [Nom] de [Nom de l'Entreprise]. On aide les industriels en Île-de-France à identifier des opportunités de robotisation sans engagement avec les fournisseurs. Je vois que vous êtes dans [secteur]—est-ce que vous avez déjà exploré l'automatisation pour [douleur spécifique, ex : manutention, emballage] ? »

Hook : « On a aidé [Client Similar] à réduire leurs coûts de main-d'œuvre de 30% avec un cobot de palettisation pour €35k, avec un ROI en 14 mois. Est-ce que c'est le genre de résultat qui vous intéresserait ? »

Discovery :

1. « Quels sont vos 2–3 plus gros défis opérationnels aujourd'hui ? »
2. « Avez-vous déjà un budget alloué pour l'automatisation ? »
3. « Quel est votre processus de décision pour ce type de projet ? »

Close : « Parfait. On propose un audit payant de 1 jour (€2,500) avec un rapport ROI clé en main. Si on trouve une opportunité, on vous connecte avec les meilleurs fournisseurs sans frais supplémentaires. Ça vous dit ? »

Gatekeeper : « Je peux vous envoyer un email avec notre offre d'audit. Pouvez-vous me donner l'email du responsable production ? »

Voicemail : « Bonjour [Prénom], je suis [Nom] de [Entreprise]. On aide les industriels à identifier des économies via la robotique. Je vous rappelle demain à [heure]. Au revoir ! »

🇬🇧 English

Opening: "Hello [First Name], this is [Name] from [Company]. We help manufacturers in Île-de-France identify robotics opportunities without tying them to any vendor. I see you're in [industry]—have you explored automation for [specific pain, e.g., material handling, packaging]?"

Hook: "We helped [Similar Client] cut labour costs by 30% with a €35k cobot palletiser, with ROI in 14 months. Is that the kind of result you'd be interested in?"

Discovery:

1. "What are your top 2–3 operational challenges right now?"
2. "Do you have a budget allocated for automation?"
3. "What's your decision-making process for this type of project?"

Close: "Great. We offer a 1-day paid audit (€2,500) with a ready-to-use ROI report. If we find an opportunity, we'll connect you with the best vendors at no extra cost. Does that work for you?"

Gatekeeper: "I can send an email with our audit offer. Could you give me the email of the production manager?"

Voicemail: "Hi [First Name], this is [Name] from [Company]. We help manufacturers save money with robotics. I'll call you back tomorrow at [time]. Goodbye!"

3️⃣ 10 Discovery Questions (Feed the Database)

1. What's your biggest operational bottleneck?
2. How many repetitive tasks could be automated?

3. What's your labour turnover rate?
4. Do you have safety incidents from manual handling?
5. What's your current throughput vs. target?
6. Have you budgeted for automation in the next 12 months?
7. Who is the final decision-maker for capital expenditures?
8. What's your typical project approval timeline?
9. Have you tried robotics before? If so, what happened?
10. What's your biggest concern about adopting robotics?

→ Every answer goes into the database (Airtable/Notion).

4️⃣ Qualification Grid (Score /20)

Criteria	Weight	Score (0–5)	Notes
Pain severity	3		High = 5, None = 0
Budget available	3		€50k+ = 5, €0 = 0
Decision-maker access	2		Direct = 5, Gatekeeper = 2
Timeline (0–6 months)	2		Urgent = 5, Long-term = 1
Technical fit	2		Easy use case = 5, Complex = 1
Subsidy eligibility	2		Yes = 5, No = 0
Willingness to pay for diagnostic	1		Yes = 5, Maybe = 3, No = 0
Total	**15**		**12+ = High Priority**

5️⃣ Top 5 Objections & Answers

Objection	Answer (FR)	Answer (EN)
"On n'a pas de budget."	« On peut commencer par un audit à €2,500—si on trouve une opportunité avec ROI <12 mois, vous pourrez financer le projet via les subventions (30–50% pris en charge). »	"We can start with a €2,500 audit. If we find an opportunity with <12-month ROI, you can fund it via grants (30–50% covered)."
"On a déjà un fournisseur."	« Super ! On peut vous aider à comparer les offres et négocier de meilleurs termes. On a accès à 50+ fournisseurs mondiaux—vous pourriez économiser 10–20%. »	"Great! We can help you compare offers and negotiate better terms. We have access to 50+ global vendors—you could save 10–20%."
"C'est trop cher."	« Le coût moyen d'un cobot est €30k–50k, mais avec les subventions, ça peut descendre à €15k–25k. Et le ROI est souvent <18 mois. »	"The average cobot costs €30k–50k, but with grants, it can drop to €15k–25k. ROI is often <18 months."
"On n'a pas les compétences en interne."	« C'est pour ça qu'on existe ! On vous accompagne de l'audit à la mise en service, et on vous connecte avec des intégrateurs certifiés. »	"That's why we exist! We guide you from audit to deployment and connect you with certified integrators."
"On attend de voir."	« Les subventions France 2030 sont disponibles maintenant—si vous attendez, vous risquez de les perdre. On peut faire un audit rapide pour voir si vous êtes éligible. »	"France 2030 grants are available now—if you wait, you might lose them. We can do a quick audit to check eligibility."

6️⃣ Follow-Up Email Template (FR + EN)

🇫🇷 **Sujet :** Audit Robotique – [Nom de l'Entreprise]

Bonjour [Prénom],

Merci pour notre échange hier. Comme discuté, on propose un audit robotique de 1 jour (€2,500) pour identifier des opportunités d'automatisation avec un ROI garanti <18 mois.

Voici ce que vous recevrez :
✅ Rapport détaillé avec 2–3 solutions prioritaires
✅ Analyse ROI (coûts, économies, subventions applicables)
✅ Shortlist de 3 fournisseurs (prix, délais, certifications)
✅ Plan de déploiement clé en main

Prochaines étapes :

1. Confirmer une date pour l'audit ([lien Calendly]).
2. Signer la convention d'audit (jointe).
3. Payer 50% à la réservation (facture jointe).

PS : Les subventions Bpifrance et Région IDF peuvent couvrir 30–50% du coût du projet. On vous aide à les obtenir.

Bien cordialement,
[Votre Nom]
[Votre Email] | [Votre Téléphone]

🇬🇧 **Subject:** Robotics Audit – [Company Name]

Hi [First Name],

Thanks for our call yesterday. As discussed, we offer a 1-day robotics audit (€2,500) to identify automation opportunities with a guaranteed ROI <18 months.

Here's what you'll get:
✅ Detailed report with 2–3 priority solutions
✅ ROI analysis (costs, savings, applicable grants)
✅ Shortlist of 3 vendors (pricing, lead times, certifications)
✅ Ready-to-use deployment plan

Next steps:

1. Confirm a date for the audit ([Calendly link]).
2. Sign the audit agreement (attached).
3. Pay 50% upfront (invoice attached).

PS: Bpifrance and Région IDF grants can cover 30–50% of the project cost. We'll help you apply.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Email] | [Your Phone]

7️⃣ LinkedIn Message Template (FR + EN)

🇫🇷 **Sujet :** Réduire vos coûts de main-d'œuvre de 30% avec la robotique

Bonjour [Prénom],

Je travaille avec des industriels en Île-de-France pour identifier des économies rapides via la robotique. Par exemple, on a aidé [Client] à réduire leurs coûts de 30% avec un cobot de palettisation pour €35k, avec un ROI en 14 mois.

Est-ce que c'est le genre de résultat qui vous intéresserait ? Je peux vous offrir un audit gratuit de 30 minutes pour explorer les opportunités.

Disponible pour en discuter ?

Cordialement,
[Votre Nom]

🇬🇧 **Subject:** Cut Labour Costs by 30% with Robotics

Hi [First Name],

I work with manufacturers in Île-de-France to identify quick savings through robotics. For example, we helped [Client] reduce costs by 30% with a €35k cobot palletiser, with ROI in 14 months.

Is this the kind of result you'd be interested in? I can offer a free 30-minute call to explore opportunities.

Available to chat?

Best,
[Your Name]

🎯 Cheat Sheet (1-Page, Print This)

📌 Our Model (Phase 1)

We are: The neutral robotics advisor for SMEs in Île-de-France.

We sell:

1. Paid diagnostics (€2,500/audit) → ROI report + vendor shortlist.
2. Subsidy filing (10–15% of grant) → €5k–15k/file.
3. Referral fees (3–10% of project) → €1.5k–5k.

We avoid: Importing hardware, long sales cycles, thin margins.

📞 Cold-Call Script (30 Seconds)

FR : « Bonjour [Prénom], je m'appelle [Nom]. On aide les industriels en IDF à identifier des économies avec la robotique. Par exemple, on a aidé [Client] à réduire leurs coûts de 30% avec un cobot à €35k, ROI en 14 mois. Seriez-vous ouvert à un audit de 1 jour à €2,500 ? »

EN: "Hi [First Name], I'm [Name]. We help manufacturers in IDF save money with robotics. For example, we helped [Client] cut costs by 30% with a €35k cobot, ROI in 14 months. Would you be open to a 1-day audit for €2,500?"

💰 Pricing (Phase 1)

Service	Price	Time to Deliver
Diagnostic Audit	€2,500	1 day
Subsidy Filing	10–15% of grant	30–60 days
Referral Fee	5–10% of project	At deployment
AMO (Project Mgmt)	15% of project	3–6 months

⚡ Top 3 Use Cases (Phase 1)

1. **Cobot Palletising** (€30k–50k, ROI 12–18 months).
2. **Autonomous Mobile Robots (AMRs)** (€50k–100k, ROI 18–24 months).
3. **Machine Tending** (€40k–80k, ROI 12–24 months).

🎯 ICP (Ideal Customer)

- **Industry:** Manufacturing (NAF 10–33), Logistics (NAF 49–52).
- **Size:** 50–500 employees, €5M–50M revenue.
- **Pain:** Labour shortages, repetitive tasks, safety incidents.
- **Budget:** €30k–200k for first project.
- **Decision Maker:** FR: Responsable Production / Logistique. EN: Production/Logistics Manager.

🚨 Red Flags (Avoid These Clients)

❌ No budget (even for audit).
❌ No pain ("Everything is fine").
❌ Long decision cycles (>12 months).
❌ No decision-maker access (only gatekeepers).
❌ Unrealistic expectations ("We want a humanoid for €10k").

🔥 Next Actions (Today)

- **Founder A:** Pull 50-target list from Kompass/Societe.com (NAF 10–33, 49–52).
- **Founder B:** Make 10 cold calls using script.
- **Both:** Set up CRM (HubSpot/Airtable) and import leads.